

marrying her because of his poverty, he could never love another woman. Yet solid evidence for this relationship, beyond the fact that she performed some of his music, is scant. Lack of evidence for any romantic attachments to women has led to speculation that Schubert was gay—and it is certain that close male friendships were at the heart of his way of life. It is clear at least that he had a sex life, for in 1822 he contracted syphilis, suffering a severe bout of the illness which disabled him for over a year and from which he may never have completely recovered.



THERESE GROB

In his teens, Schubert developed an affection for baker's daughter Therese Grob. It is